Lok Sabha in an important debate in 2015, the Constitution-makers did not insert the words 'secular' and 'socialist' in the Preamble. These words were inserted only by the 42nd Amendment in 1976. 'If the words "secularism" and "socialism" had been essential,' he said, 'then definitely Babasaheb Bhimrao Ambedkar would have used them in the Preamble to the Constitution.' He did not use them, said Singh, because he believed that it was already included in India's 'core nature', its 'core character'. 'There is no need to add it separately in the Preamble', which was the spirit, or 'aatma', of the Constitution. Where does this leave secularism as we have understood it? As Singh put it, 'Translating the Indian Constitution, the formal translation of secular is *panth-nirpeksh* [community-neutral], not *dharm-nirpeksh* [religion-neutral]. India's religion by itself is *panth-nirpeksh* [community-neutral].'

This redefinition of 'secularism'—the most 'misused' word in India politics, according to the BJP—is precisely what Yogi Adityanath often refers to (see Chapter 1). It is also what RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat alluded to in Ayodhya when he spoke of the 'Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam' philosophy of ancient India. Based on what the BJP sees as an essential tolerance in Hinduism itself, which saw ancient migrants like Parsis finding a home in India, it seeks to do away with all 'tokenism' to minorities. How the party plays this card and manages social balance will be crucial to its future.

As Rajnath Singh said in the Lok Sabha, 'The Muslim community has 72 sects … India is the only country in the world which has all 72 sects … yet Babasaheb Ambedkar did not use the word secular.' For those who think of secularism as 'dharm-nirpeksh', Singh pointed to the ancient Mauryan seal above the Lok Sabha Speaker's chair in Parliament, with the Mauryan lion and its pre-Common Era slogan 'Dharm-chakra Pravartanay' (protector of the dharm chakra). 'Should we remove that too?' he asked.[74]

BJP's Advantage 1: A Robust Booth-level Cadre and Organisational Structure